



# HR INTERVIEW SUCCESS PLAYBOOK 2026

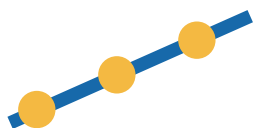
From Fresher to Interview-Ready

Resume • 50 Interview Questions • Recruitment • HR Letters • Payroll • Excel • Communication  
• 90-Day Roadmap

**Practical Edition for India**

HR Freshers • MBA HR Students • Career Switchers • Junior HR Executives

# How to Use This Book



## Step 1 — Build the foundation

Read Chapters 1–3 first. Understand what HR work looks like, identify your skill gaps and improve your resume.

## Step 2 — Practise interviews

Do not memorise answers word-for-word. Learn the structure, then answer using your genuine education, internship, project or work examples.

## Step 3 — Learn practical HR

Study recruitment, documentation, payroll concepts, Excel and communication so you can explain how work flows in a real HR team.

## Step 4 — Prepare for the job

Use the 30-day and 90-day roadmaps after you get an offer.

This book is educational. Employment law, payroll, PF, ESI, tax and company policies can change. Verify current official requirements before operational use.

# Table of Contents



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# Chapter 1 — What Does HR Actually Do?



## HR is a business function

HR helps an organisation attract, organise, develop and retain people while supporting fair, consistent and compliant workplace processes.

## The employee lifecycle

Workforce need → recruitment → selection → offer → joining → onboarding → performance and development → engagement → payroll/benefits coordination → separation.

## What a fresher should understand

You do not need to be an expert in every HR area. You should understand the purpose of each major function and be able to explain basic workflows clearly.

# HR Career Paths Explained



## HR Recruiter / Talent Acquisition

Sources candidates, screens profiles, coordinates interviews, maintains candidate communication and supports hiring closure.

## HR Operations

Handles employee records, letters, attendance/leave processes, HR systems, joining and exit administration.

## HR Generalist

Works across multiple areas such as recruitment, operations, engagement, employee queries and policy support.

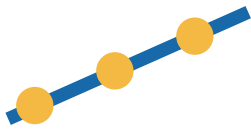
## Payroll / Compensation

Coordinates salary inputs, deductions, benefits and payroll processes. Accuracy and confidentiality are critical.

## Learning & Development

Supports training needs, learning programmes, attendance, feedback and capability development.

# Which HR Role Fits You?



## **If you enjoy communication**

Recruitment or talent acquisition may suit you.

## **If you enjoy process and accuracy**

HR operations, HRIS administration or payroll support may be a better fit.

## **If you want broad exposure**

A junior HR generalist role can provide experience across several HR functions.

## **Decision exercise**

Write your top three strengths, three activities you enjoy and three HR tasks you want to practise. Compare them with job descriptions before applying.

# A Typical Day for a Junior HR Executive



## Morning

Check joining status, interview schedule, employee queries and pending approvals. Update trackers.

## Mid-day

Screen resumes, coordinate interviews, prepare authorised documents, update HR systems and follow up with managers.

## Afternoon

Support onboarding, reports, attendance/leave inputs, employee communication or engagement tasks.

## End of day

Close follow-ups, update status trackers and identify tomorrow's priorities.

# HR Ethics & Confidentiality



## Confidentiality

Employee salary, personal data, performance information and complaints should be accessed and shared only for legitimate authorised work.

## Fairness

Use job-related criteria and consistent processes. Avoid assumptions based on irrelevant personal characteristics.

## Accuracy

Check names, dates, salary details, job titles and approvals before sending HR documents.

## When unsure

Do not invent policy or legal answers. Check the approved policy, responsible HR leader or official source.



# Chapter 2 — What Employers Expect From HR Freshers



## Communication

Clear speaking, listening, email writing and professional candidate/employee interaction.

## Process understanding

Basic knowledge of recruitment, onboarding, documentation, attendance, payroll concepts and HR records.

## Reliability

Following up, meeting deadlines, maintaining trackers and escalating issues early.

## Learning attitude

Being able to say “I do not know yet, but I know how I would verify it” is better than guessing.

# HR Fresher Skills Scorecard



Rate yourself from 1 (needs major improvement) to 5 (confident):

Communication \_\_\_\_ / 5 Recruitment \_\_\_\_ / 5 Documentation \_\_\_\_ / 5

Excel \_\_\_\_ / 5 Email writing \_\_\_\_ / 5 Confidentiality \_\_\_\_ / 5

Interview coordination \_\_\_\_ / 5 Time management \_\_\_\_ / 5

Pick the three lowest scores. These become your 30-day learning priorities.

# Professional Behaviour That Builds Trust



## Be prepared

Read the job description and meeting context before speaking with candidates, employees or managers.

## Be precise

Do not casually promise salary, joining dates, approvals or policy exceptions.

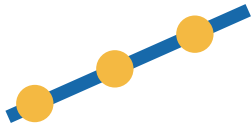
## Follow through

If you say you will update someone by a certain time, do it or communicate the delay.

## Keep records

Important recruitment and employee-process actions should be recorded in the approved system or tracker.

# 30-Day Skill Improvement Plan



## Week 1

Learn HR vocabulary, recruitment flow and professional email structure.

## Week 2

Build a sample candidate tracker and practise Excel basics.

## Week 3

Practise 25 interview questions and improve your resume.

## Week 4

Practise the remaining questions, run two mock interviews and revise payroll/document concepts.

## Chapter 3 — Build a Job-Winning HR Resume



### The goal

Your resume should help a recruiter understand your fit in seconds. Make it relevant, readable and truthful.

### Recommended order

Name & contact → professional summary → education → HR skills → internship/projects → certifications → achievements.

### Length

For many freshers, one well-structured page is enough. Use a second page only when relevant information genuinely requires it.

# Professional Summary — Formula



## Formula

Who you are + relevant exposure + useful skills + target direction.

## Example

MBA HR graduate with internship exposure to resume screening, interview coordination and employee documentation. Comfortable with Excel, candidate communication and structured follow-up; seeking an entry-level HR operations or recruitment role.

## Avoid

Generic statements such as “hardworking person seeking a challenging position” without evidence.

# How to Write Internship Experience



## **Weak**

Helped HR team with recruitment.

## **Better**

Supported resume screening and interview scheduling for entry-level roles; maintained candidate status updates and coordinated interview confirmations under supervisor guidance.

## **Important**

Use only tasks you genuinely performed. Do not add fake hiring numbers, fake percentages or tools you have never used.

# HR Resume Skills Section



Relevant examples: Recruitment coordination • Resume screening • Candidate communication • Employee documentation • MS Excel • HR reporting • Professional email writing • Onboarding support.

Separate actual skills from skills you are currently learning.

Tailor the section to the job description, but never copy keywords you cannot explain in an interview.



# Resume Final Checklist



- Contact details are correct
- Summary matches the target HR role
- Education and dates are accurate
- Internship/project bullets explain actual work
- Skills are interview-defensible
- Formatting is consistent
- No spelling mistakes
- File name is professional, e.g., FirstName\_LastName\_HR\_Resume.pdf

## Chapter 4 — 50 HR Interview Questions



### How to practise

Read the question, understand the framework, write your own answer and speak it aloud. Aim for clarity rather than memorisation.

### STAR method

Situation → Task → Action → Result. Use it for behavioural questions and real examples.

# Interview Practice — Questions 1–3



## 1. Tell me about yourself.

**Answer framework:** Use Present → Relevant Past → Future. Mention education, HR exposure, 2–3 strengths and target role.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## 2. Why did you choose HR?

**Answer framework:** Connect your interest to real HR work: recruitment, employee experience, operations or learning.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## 3. Why should we hire you?

**Answer framework:** Match your skills to the JD and demonstrate reliability, communication and willingness to learn.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Interview Practice — Questions 4–6



### 4. What are your strengths?

**Answer framework:** Give 2–3 job-relevant strengths with brief evidence.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 5. What weakness are you improving?

**Answer framework:** Choose a genuine manageable weakness and explain your improvement action.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 6. What is recruitment?

**Answer framework:** The process of identifying a hiring need, attracting candidates, screening and moving suitable applicants through hiring.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

# Interview Practice — Questions 7–9



## 7. Recruitment vs selection?

**Answer framework:** Recruitment builds the candidate pool; selection evaluates and chooses the suitable candidate.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## 8. Explain the recruitment process.

**Answer framework:** Requirement → JD → sourcing → screening → interviews → selection → offer → joining → onboarding.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## 9. What is sourcing?

**Answer framework:** Finding potential candidates using job portals, professional networks, referrals, databases and career channels.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

# Interview Practice — Questions 10–12



## 10. How do you screen a resume?

**Answer framework:** Compare job-related requirements with relevant skills, experience and education consistently.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## 11. What is telephone screening?

**Answer framework:** A short initial call to validate key requirements, interest, availability and relevant background.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## 12. What is a job description?

**Answer framework:** A document describing role purpose, responsibilities, reporting relationship, required skills and qualifications.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Interview Practice — Questions 13–15



### 13. How do you schedule interviews?

**Answer framework:** Coordinate availability, confirm format/location/link, send clear details and follow up.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 14. What is onboarding?

**Answer framework:** Helping a new employee integrate through documentation, orientation, access, role clarity and early support.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 15. Induction vs onboarding?

**Answer framework:** Induction is usually the initial introduction; onboarding is a broader integration process.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Interview Practice — Questions 16–18



### 16. What is employee engagement?

**Answer framework:** Conditions and activities that support employee involvement, connection and commitment.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 17. What is performance appraisal?

**Answer framework:** A structured process to review performance, feedback, goals and development.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 18. KRA vs KPI?

**Answer framework:** KRA is a key result/responsibility area; KPI is a measurable indicator of progress or performance.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_



# Interview Practice — Questions 19–21



## 19. What is attrition?

**Answer framework:** Employees leaving an organisation over a period; HR may analyse rates and reasons.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## 20. What is retention?

**Answer framework:** The organisation's ability and efforts to keep employees.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## 21. How would you handle an employee complaint?

**Answer framework:** Listen, document facts appropriately, maintain confidentiality, follow policy and escalate when required.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Interview Practice — Questions 22–24



### 22. How do you maintain confidentiality?

**Answer framework:** Use information only for authorised work and follow access/security controls.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 23. How do you handle conflict?

**Answer framework:** Understand perspectives, focus on facts, remain neutral and follow policy/escalation processes.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 24. What is payroll?

**Answer framework:** The process of calculating and administering employee pay from authorised earnings, inputs and deductions.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

# Interview Practice — Questions 25–27



## 25. What is CTC?

**Answer framework:** Cost to Company is an employer compensation-cost concept; it is not automatically take-home salary.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## 26. Gross vs net salary?

**Answer framework:** Gross generally means earnings before applicable deductions; net is what remains after applicable deductions.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## 27. What is basic salary?

**Answer framework:** A core salary component whose treatment depends on compensation structure and applicable rules.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Interview Practice — Questions 28–30



### 28. What is HRA?

**Answer framework:** House Rent Allowance is a salary component used by many Indian employers; tax treatment depends on current law and circumstances.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 29. What are PF and ESI?

**Answer framework:** Indian social-security schemes with eligibility and contribution rules. Verify current EPFO/ESIC guidance.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 30. What is professional tax?

**Answer framework:** A state-level levy applicable in certain states; applicability and amount vary.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Interview Practice — Questions 31–33



### 31. What is TDS?

**Answer framework:** Tax Deducted at Source is a withholding mechanism under applicable income-tax provisions.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 32. What Excel skills should HR know?

**Answer framework:** Sort, Filter, Tables, IF, COUNTIF, SUMIF/SUMIFS, lookups, dates, conditional formatting and PivotTables.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 33. What is XLOOKUP?

**Answer framework:** A lookup function used to return matching information from a range in supported Excel versions.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Interview Practice — Questions 34–36



### 34. What is a PivotTable?

**Answer framework:** A tool for summarising tabular data by categories, counts, sums and other aggregations.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 35. How do you write a professional HR email?

**Answer framework:** Clear subject, greeting, concise purpose, required details, next action and professional closing.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 36. How do you reject a candidate professionally?

**Answer framework:** Be respectful and clear, avoid unnecessary judgments and use approved communication.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Interview Practice — Questions 37–39



### 37. What creates a good candidate experience?

**Answer framework:** Clear communication, realistic timelines, respect, accurate interview information and updates.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 38. What is HRIS?

**Answer framework:** A system supporting HR data and processes such as employee records, attendance or leave.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 39. How do you prioritise vacancies?

**Answer framework:** Consider urgency, business criticality, ageing, difficulty and agreed deadlines.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Interview Practice — Questions 40–42



### 40. What if a selected candidate does not join?

**Answer framework:** Inform the team, understand the reason where possible, review backup candidates and improve follow-up.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 41. How do you work with a difficult hiring manager?

**Answer framework:** Clarify requirements, agree timelines, use evidence, communicate constraints and document decisions.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 42. What is an exit interview?

**Answer framework:** A structured discussion with a departing employee about their experience and reasons for leaving.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_



## Interview Practice — Questions 43–45



### 43. What is training need analysis?

**Answer framework:** Identifying capability gaps so learning interventions can be targeted.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 44. What is HR compliance?

**Answer framework:** Following applicable employment laws, regulations, policies and required processes.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 45. What if you don't know an answer?

**Answer framework:** Be transparent, state what you understand and explain how you would verify the correct answer.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Interview Practice — Questions 46–48



### 46. Where do you see yourself in three years?

**Answer framework:** Describe realistic growth in fundamentals, ownership and a chosen HR speciality.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 47. Why do you want to work here?

**Answer framework:** Use genuine company research and connect the role to your career direction.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 48. Describe a difficult situation.

**Answer framework:** Use STAR: Situation, Task, Action, Result. Keep it truthful and relevant.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Interview Practice — Questions 49–50



### 49. How do you manage deadlines?

**Answer framework:** Prioritise by urgency/impact, track actions, communicate risks early and close follow-ups.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 50. Do you have questions for us?

**Answer framework:** Ask about first-90-day expectations, team structure, success measures, training and current priorities.

**Your practice:** \_\_\_\_\_

# Chapter 5 — Recruitment: End-to-End



## The workflow

Hiring request → requirement intake → job description → sourcing → screening → interview → selection → offer → pre-joining → joining → onboarding.

## Why process matters

A clear workflow reduces missed follow-ups, inconsistent communication and avoidable hiring delays.

# Step 1 — Requirement Intake



Confirm role title, department, reporting manager, responsibilities, must-have skills, preferred skills, experience range, location/work model, interview stages, target timeline and authorised compensation information.

Ask the hiring manager what would make a candidate unsuitable. This helps screening stay focused.

## Step 2 — Job Description



### Include

Role purpose, key responsibilities, essential skills, preferred skills, education/experience requirements and work location/model.

### Avoid

Inflated requirements, unclear responsibilities and criteria unrelated to the job.

## Step 3 — Sourcing Candidates



Possible channels include company career pages, job portals, professional networks, referrals, approved databases, campus sources and agencies.

Track source quality rather than assuming more profiles means better recruitment.

## Step 4 — Resume & Phone Screening



### Resume screening

Use consistent job-related criteria. Record why a profile moves forward or does not.

### Phone screening

Confirm relevant background, role interest, availability and key requirements. Do not ask intrusive questions unrelated to the job.



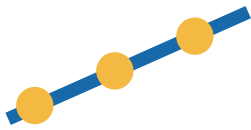
## Step 5 — Interview Coordination



Confirm date, time, mode, interviewer, location/link and any preparation instructions.

Send confirmation to the candidate and interviewer. Update the tracker immediately after each stage.

## Step 6 — Offer to Onboarding



After authorised selection, use approved offer processes. Maintain professional pre-joining communication. On joining, complete required documentation, orientation, system/access steps and role introductions according to company process.

## Chapter 6 — HR Letters & Documents



### Golden rule

Use company-approved templates and authorised terms. The samples below are educational structures, not legal templates.

### Before sending any letter

Verify employee/candidate name, role, dates, compensation information, approver, policy basis and attachments.

# Interview Invitation



## Subject: Interview Invitation — [Role]

Dear [Candidate Name],

Thank you for your interest in the [Role] position at [Company]. We would like to invite you to an interview on [Date] at [Time] via [Mode/Location].

Please confirm your availability by replying to this message. If the interview is online, the meeting link is [Link].

Regards,  
[HR Name]  
[Company]

Training note: Replace placeholders only with verified, authorised information. Do not treat sample wording as jurisdiction-specific legal advice.

# Offer Letter — Educational Structure



## Subject: Employment Offer — [Role]

Dear [Candidate Name],

We are pleased to communicate our offer for the position of [Role], subject to the organisation's approved terms, required documentation and applicable conditions. Your proposed joining date is [Date]. The authorised compensation details and employment terms are provided in the attached/approved offer document.

Please review the official document and confirm acceptance as instructed.

Regards,

[Authorised HR/Signatory]

Training note: Replace placeholders only with verified, authorised information. Do not treat sample wording as jurisdiction-specific legal advice.

# Appointment Letter — Educational Structure



## Purpose

An appointment letter commonly records formal employment terms such as role, joining date, reporting relationship, compensation structure, probation/confirmation terms where applicable, working conditions, confidentiality and other approved clauses. Because legal and policy requirements vary, use only the employer's reviewed template.

Training note: Replace placeholders only with verified, authorised information. Do not treat sample wording as jurisdiction-specific legal advice.

# Employee Welcome Email



## Subject: Welcome to [Company]

Dear [Employee Name],

Welcome to [Company]. We are glad to have you join us as [Role] on [Date]. Please report to [Location/Person] at [Time]. Your onboarding schedule and required joining information are [attached/provided below].

We look forward to working with you.

Regards,

HR Team

Training note: Replace placeholders only with verified, authorised information. Do not treat sample wording as jurisdiction-specific legal advice.

# Candidate Rejection Email



## Subject: Update on Your Application — [Role]

Dear [Candidate Name],

Thank you for the time and effort you invested in our selection process. After review, we will not be progressing your application for this position.

We appreciate your interest in [Company] and wish you well in your job search.

Regards,  
HR Team

Training note: Replace placeholders only with verified, authorised information. Do not treat sample wording as jurisdiction-specific legal advice.



# Experience Letter — Educational Structure



## Purpose and sample wording

This is to confirm that [Employee Name] was employed with [Company] as [Designation] from [Start Date] to [End Date], according to company records. Any additional wording about duties, conduct or performance should follow authorised company policy and verified records.

Training note: Replace placeholders only with verified, authorised information. Do not treat sample wording as jurisdiction-specific legal advice.

# Relieving Letter — Educational Structure



## Purpose and sample wording

This is to confirm that [Employee Name], [Designation], has been relieved from duties effective [Date], following completion of the organisation's approved separation process. Include only verified and authorised details.

Training note: Replace placeholders only with verified, authorised information. Do not treat sample wording as jurisdiction-specific legal advice.

# Warning Letter — Use With Care



## Structure

Subject/issue → verified facts → relevant policy/expectation → required corrective action → timeline → consequences/process as authorised → acknowledgement where applicable. Disciplinary communication can have legal and employee-relations implications; do not improvise wording without authorised review.

Training note: Replace placeholders only with verified, authorised information. Do not treat sample wording as jurisdiction-specific legal advice.

# Increment / Salary Revision Letter



## Structure

Effective date → revised authorised compensation information → any changed designation/terms if approved → statement that other terms remain as applicable → authorised signatory. Double-check every figure before issue.

Training note: Replace placeholders only with verified, authorised information. Do not treat sample wording as jurisdiction-specific legal advice.

# Leave Approval / Confirmation Email



## Subject: Leave Request — Status

Dear [Employee Name],

Your leave request for [Date/Period] has been [approved/recorded] according to the applicable process. Please ensure required handover or reporting steps are completed.

Regards,  
[Manager/HR]

Training note: Replace placeholders only with verified, authorised information. Do not treat sample wording as jurisdiction-specific legal advice.

# Exit / Full-and-Final Process Email



## Subject: Separation Process — Next Steps

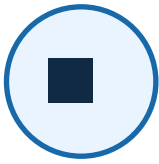
Dear [Employee Name],

This message outlines the next steps in the approved separation process, including [handover / asset return / documentation / exit discussion / payroll processing as applicable]. Please complete the listed actions by [Date] and contact [Responsible Person] for questions.

Regards,  
HR Team

Training note: Replace placeholders only with verified, authorised information. Do not treat sample wording as jurisdiction-specific legal advice.

## Chapter 7 — Salary & Payroll Basics



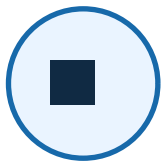
### Think in layers

Compensation structure → authorised earnings → applicable deductions/contributions → payroll calculation → payslip/net payment.

### Do not confuse

CTC, gross salary and take-home pay are different concepts. Exact definitions can vary by employer structure.

# Common Salary Components



## Basic salary

A core component in many salary structures.

## HRA

House Rent Allowance is used by many Indian employers.

## Allowances

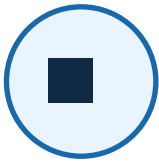
May include components defined by the employer's compensation structure.

## Deductions

May include applicable statutory deductions, tax withholding, authorised recoveries or other items.



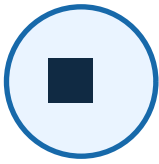
# PF, ESI, Professional Tax & TDS



These topics are important for interviews, but operational rates, thresholds, eligibility and treatment can change or depend on circumstances.

Learn what each item means. For actual payroll work, verify current official EPFO, ESIC, tax and relevant state guidance rather than relying on an interview guide.

## Payroll Example — Concept Only

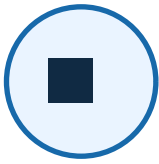


Suppose an employee has authorised gross monthly earnings of ■30,000. You cannot correctly calculate final take-home pay from that number alone.

You would need the actual salary structure, attendance/payable days where relevant, applicable deductions, tax information and other authorised payroll inputs.

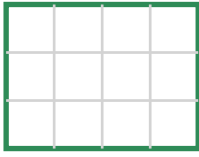
This is a strong interview answer because it shows you understand the process without inventing figures.

# Payroll Accuracy Checklist



- Employee master data verified
- Attendance/leave inputs authorised
- New joiners and exits updated
- Salary revisions approved
- Applicable deductions reviewed
- Bank/payment data handled securely
- Payroll output reviewed before release
- Payslips/reports distributed through approved channels

## Chapter 8 — Excel Skills for HR



10 practical skills: Sort • Filter • Excel Tables • IF • COUNTIF • SUMIF/SUMIFS • XLOOKUP/VLOOKUP • Date functions • Conditional Formatting • PivotTables.

Practise on fictional data until you can explain what each tool solves.

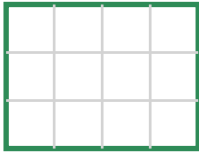
# HR Candidate Tracker — Suggested Columns

|  |  |  |  |
|--|--|--|--|
|  |  |  |  |
|  |  |  |  |
|  |  |  |  |

Candidate ID | Candidate Name | Role | Source | Application Date | Screening Status | Interview Date | Interviewer | Current Stage | Last Follow-Up | Next Action | Final Status

Use dropdowns/data validation where appropriate to keep statuses consistent.

# Useful Formula Practice



## COUNTIF

Count how many candidates are in a particular stage.

## SUMIF / SUMIFS

Summarise numeric values based on one or more criteria.

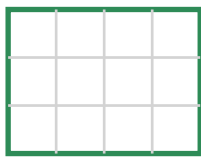
## XLOOKUP / VLOOKUP

Retrieve related information from a reference table.

## IF

Return different outputs based on a logical condition.

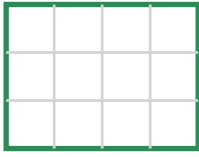
# PivotTables for HR



Use a PivotTable to answer questions such as: How many candidates came from each source? How many are at each stage? How many hires were made by role?

Always check that source data is clean and that the PivotTable has been refreshed.

# HR Data Privacy in Spreadsheets



Use fictional data for learning. Real employee and candidate data should be stored and shared only through authorised systems and approved access.

Do not casually email salary sheets, identity documents or employee databases to personal accounts.



## Chapter 9 — Professional HR Communication



### The 6-part email formula

Subject → greeting → purpose → essential details → next action → professional closing.

### Before sending

Check recipient, name, role, date, time, attachment and meeting link.

# Interview Follow-Up Messages



## Candidate reminder

Dear [Name], this is a reminder for your interview for [Role] on [Date] at [Time] via [Mode]. Please confirm that you are available.

## Post-interview update

Dear [Name], thank you for attending the interview. Your application is currently under review. We will share the next update according to our recruitment timeline.

# How to Communicate Delays



Do not disappear when a process is delayed. Send a short factual update without promising an outcome you cannot control.

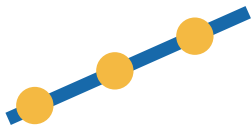
**Example:** Thank you for your patience. The selection process for [Role] is taking longer than originally expected. Your application remains under review, and we will share an update when the next step is confirmed.

# WhatsApp / Chat Etiquette for HR



Keep messages professional and concise. Introduce yourself and company context, avoid late-night messages unless genuinely necessary, do not send confidential documents casually, and move formal decisions to approved channels where required.

# Chapter 10 — Your First 30 Days in HR



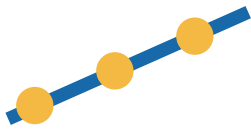
## Days 1–7 — Understand

Learn structure, reporting lines, policies, HR systems, confidentiality rules and your team's standard operating procedures.

### Goal

Know who owns each process and where approved information lives.

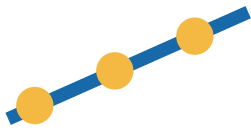
## Days 8–15 — Practise



With supervision, practise recruitment coordination, employee documentation, trackers, candidate communication and joining processes.

Ask for feedback on accuracy and tone before trying to become faster.

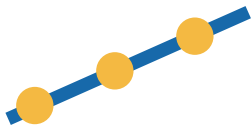
## Days 16–23 — Build Process Accuracy



Understand attendance/leave workflows, authorised payroll inputs, HR reports, recurring deadlines and escalation points relevant to your role.

Create your own process notes without copying confidential data.

## Days 24–30 — Improve

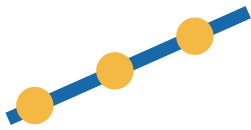


Review errors, repeated questions and slow tasks. Improve Excel, email writing and follow-up discipline.

Ask your manager: What should I be able to handle independently by the end of the next 30 days?



# Chapter 11 — 90-Day HR Career Growth Roadmap



## Month 1 — Learn

Build reliable foundations in recruitment, documentation, communication and confidentiality.

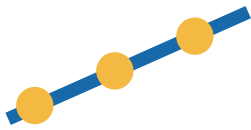
## Month 2 — Practise

Take supervised ownership of recurring tasks, Excel trackers, reporting and coordination.

## Month 3 — Grow

Review measurable progress and choose one HR area to deepen.

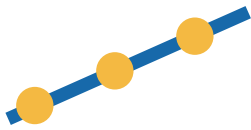
# Build Your HR Portfolio



Create only fictional or sanitised examples: a candidate tracker, interview schedule, sample JD, onboarding checklist, recruitment funnel summary and professional email samples.

Never put confidential employer/candidate data into a public portfolio.

# Your Next 90-Day Goals



Goal 1: \_\_\_\_\_

Goal 2: \_\_\_\_\_

Goal 3: \_\_\_\_\_

Skill to deepen: \_\_\_\_\_

Evidence I will create: \_\_\_\_\_

# Bonus 1 — 7-Day Interview Preparation Plan



Day 1 — Research company and JD

Day 2 — Prepare introduction, strengths and career motivation

Day 3 — Revise recruitment and HR operations

Day 4 — Revise payroll concepts and Excel

Day 5 — Prepare three genuine STAR stories

Day 6 — Complete a mock interview

Day 7 — Final resume, logistics and question review

## Bonus 2 — Mock Interview Scorecard



Score 1–5: Introduction \_\_\_\_ HR fundamentals \_\_\_\_ Recruitment \_\_\_\_ Payroll concepts \_\_\_\_ Excel \_\_\_\_

Communication \_\_\_\_ Confidence \_\_\_\_ Examples \_\_\_\_ Honesty when unsure \_\_\_\_ Questions for interviewer \_\_\_\_

Three areas to improve before the next mock interview: \_\_\_\_\_

## Bonus 3 — Interview-Day Checklist



- Research company and role
- Prepare 60-second introduction
- Review core HR concepts
- Prepare three STAR examples
- Carry/use an updated truthful resume
- Test online interview setup
- Join/arrive early
- Listen before answering
- Ask two thoughtful questions
- Follow up professionally where appropriate

## Bonus 4 — HR Glossary



### **JD**

Job Description

### **TA**

Talent Acquisition

### **HRIS**

Human Resources Information System

### **KRA**

Key Result Area / key responsibility area

### **KPI**

Key Performance Indicator

### **CTC**

Cost to Company

### **L&D;**

Learning & Development

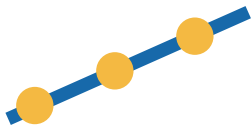
### **F&F;**

Full and Final settlement, as used in many organisations

### **TNA**

Training Need Analysis

## Bonus 5 — Final 10-Minute Revision



Recruitment flow: Requirement → sourcing → screening → interview → selection → offer → joining → onboarding.

Remember the difference between recruitment and selection, induction and onboarding, KRA and KPI, CTC/gross/net, and the purpose of common HR documents.

Your strongest interview tool is not memorisation. It is a clear explanation supported by truthful examples.





# YOU ARE INTERVIEW-READY

Prepare. Practise. Stay truthful. Keep learning.

**Final reminder:** HR professionals are trusted with people, information and processes. Accuracy, confidentiality and respectful communication matter as much as technical knowledge.